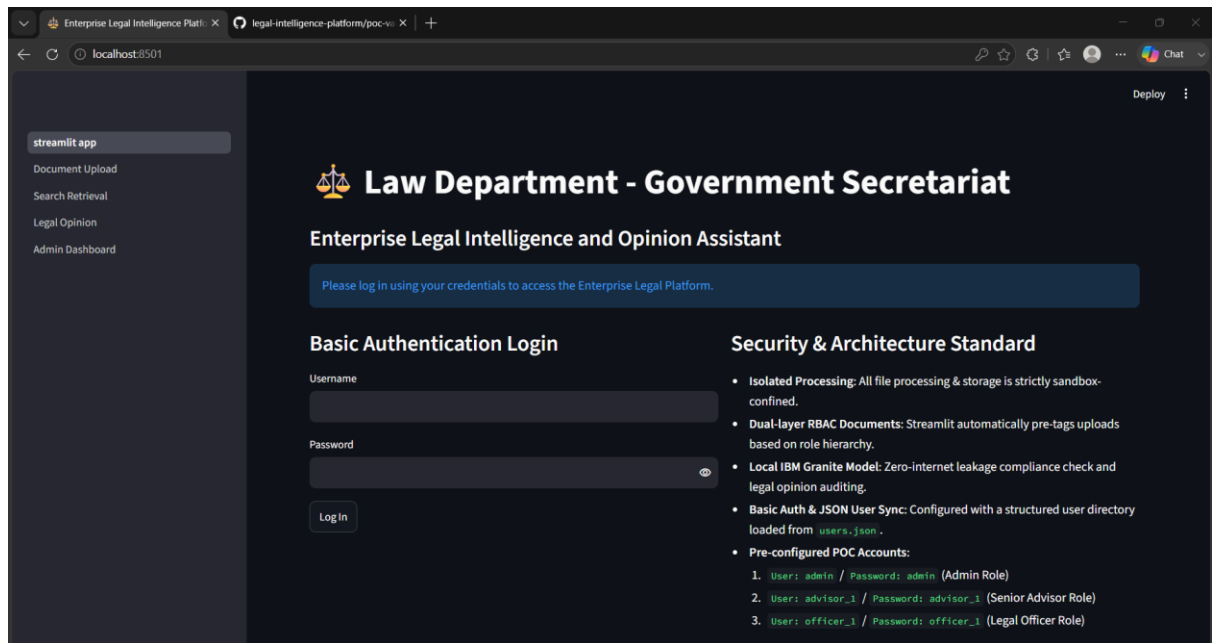


Validation Phase 1: Authentication & Account Directory

Objective: Verify that the pre-seeded accounts are loaded and that the system rejects invalid credentials.

1. **Step 1:** Open the Streamlit user portal at <http://localhost:8501>.



2. **Step 2:** Attempt to log in with an invalid user (e.g., `officer_fake` / password).
 - o **Expected Result:** The interface displays a connection error: *"Authentication failed. Check credentials."*



3. **Step 3:** Log in as officer_1 (Password: officer_1).

- **Expected Result:** Successful authentication. The app displays: "Authenticated as **officer_1** (Legal_Officer)".



4. **Step 4:** Click Log Out.

- **Expected Result:** All local memory values (chat messages, session identifiers) are cleared. The user is redirected to the login portal.

